22 And Hazael king of Aram oppressed Israel throughout the reign of Jehoahaz.
23 But the LORD was gracious to Israel and had compassion on them, and He
turned toward them because of His covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.
And to this day, the LORD has been unwilling to destroy them or cast them
from His presence. 24 When Hazael king of Aram died, his son Ben-hadad reigned
in his place. 25 Then Jehoash son of Jehoahaz took back from Ben-hadad son of
Hazael the cities that Hazael had taken in battle from his father Jehoahaz. Jehoash
defeated Ben-hadad three times, and so recovered the cities of Israel.

14 In the second year of the reign of Jehoash son of Jehoahaz over Israel,
Amaziah son of Joash became king of Judah. 2 He was twenty-five years old when
he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem twenty-nine years. His mother's
name was Jehoaddan; she was from Jerusalem. 3 And he did what was right in
the eyes of the LORD, but not as his father David had done. He did everything
as his father Joash had done. 4 Nevertheless, the high places were not taken away,
and the people continued sacrificing and burning incense on the high places. 5 As
soon as the kingdom was firmly in his grasp, Amaziah executed the servants who
had murdered his father the king. 6 Yet he did not put the sons of the murderers
to death, but acted according to what is written in the Book of the Law of Moses,
where the LORD commanded: "Fathers must not be put to death for their
children, and children must not be put to death for their fathers; each is to die
for his own sin." 7 Amaziah struck down 10,000 Edomites in the Valley of Salt.
He took Sela in battle and called it Joktheel, which is its name to this very day.
8 Then Amaziah sent messengers to the king of Israel Jehoash son of Jehoahaz,
the son of Jehu. "Come, let us meet face to face," he said.

9 But Jehoash king of Israel replied to Amaziah king of Judah: "A thistle in
Lebanon sent a message to a cedar in Lebanon, saying, 'Give your daughter to
my son in marriage.' Then a wild beast in Lebanon came along and trampled
the thistle." 10 "You have indeed defeated Edom, and your heart has become
proud. Glory in that and stay at home. Why should you stir up trouble so
that you fall—you and Judah with you?" 11 But Amaziah would not listen, and
Jehoash king of Israel advanced. He and King Amaziah of Judah faced each
other at Beth-shemesh in Judah. 12 And Judah was routed before Israel, and every
man fled to his home. 13 There at Beth-shemesh, Jehoash king of Israel captured
Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Joash, the son of Ahaziah. Then Jehoash went
to Jerusalem and broke down the wall of Jerusalem from the Ephraim Gate to
the Corner Gate—a section of four hundred cubits. 14 He took all the gold and
silver and all the articles found in the house of the LORD and in the treasuries
of the royal palace, as well as some hostages. Then he returned to Samaria. 15 As
for the rest of the acts of Jehoash, along with his accomplishments, his might,
and how he waged war against Amaziah king of Judah, are they not written in
the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? 16 And Jehoash rested with his
fathers and was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel. And his son Jeroboam
reigned in his place. 17 Amaziah son of Joash king of Judah lived for fifteen years
after the death of Jehoash son of Jehoahaz king of Israel. 18 As for the rest of
the acts of Amaziah, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the
Kings of Judah?

19 And conspirators plotted against Amaziah in Jerusalem, and he fled to Lachish.
But men were sent after him to Lachish, and they killed him there. 20 They
carried him back on horses and buried him in Jerusalem with his fathers in the
City of David.

21 Then all the people of Judah took Azariah, who was sixteen years old, and
made him king in place of his father Amaziah. 22 Azariah was the one who rebuilt
Elath and restored it to Judah after King Amaziah rested with his fathers. 23 In the
fifteenth year of the reign of Amaziah son of Joash over Judah, Jeroboam son of
Jehoash became king of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria forty-one years. 24 And
he did evil in the sight of the LORD and did not turn away from all the sins that
Jeroboam son of Nebat had caused Israel to commit. 25 This Jeroboam restored
the boundary of Israel from Lebo-hamath to the Sea of the Arabah, according
to the word that the LORD, the God of Israel, had spoken through His servant
Jonah son of Amittai, the prophet from Gath-hepher. 26 For the LORD saw
that the affliction of the Israelites, both slave and free, was very bitter. There
was no one to help Israel, 27 and since the LORD had said that He would not
blot out the name of Israel from under heaven, He saved them by the hand of
Jeroboam son of Jehoash. 28 As for the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, along with
all his accomplishments and might, and how he waged war and recovered both
Damascus and Hamath for Israel from Judah, are they not written in the Book
of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel? 29 And Jeroboam rested with his fathers,
the kings of Israel. And his son Zechariah reigned in his place.

15 In the twenty-seventh year of Jeroboam's reign over Israel, Azariah son of
Amaziah became king of Judah. 2 He was sixteen years old when he became king,
and he reigned in Jerusalem fifty-two years. His mother's name was Jecoliah; she
was from Jerusalem. 3 And he did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, just
as his father Amaziah had done. 4 Nevertheless, the high places were not taken
away; the people continued sacrificing and burning incense there. 5 And the
LORD afflicted the king with leprosy until the day he died, so that he lived in
a separate house while his son Jotham had charge of the palace and governed
the people of the land. 6 As for the rest of the acts of Azariah, along with all his
accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings
of Judah? 7 And Azariah rested with his fathers and was buried near them in the
City of David. And his son Jotham reigned in his place. 8 In the thirty-eighth year
of Azariah's reign over Judah, Zechariah son of Jeroboam became king of Israel,
and he reigned in Samaria six months. 9 And he did evil in the sight of the LORD,
as his fathers had done. He did not turn away from the sins that Jeroboam son
of Nebat had caused Israel to commit. 10 Then Shallum son of Jabesh conspired
against Zechariah, struck him down and killed him in front of the people, and
reigned in his place. 11 As for the rest of the acts of Zechariah, they are indeed
written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.

12 So the word of the LORD spoken to Jehu was fulfilled: "Four generations of
your sons will sit on the throne of Israel." 13 In the thirty-ninth year of Uzziah's
reign over Judah, Shallum son of Jabesh became king, and he reigned in Samaria
one full month. 14 Then Menahem son of Gadi went up from Tirzah to Samaria,
struck down and killed Shallum son of Jabesh, and reigned in his place. 15 As for
the rest of the acts of Shallum, along with the conspiracy he led, they are indeed
written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel.

16 At that time Menahem, starting from Tirzah, attacked Tiphsah and everyone
in its vicinity, because they would not open their gates. So he attacked Tiphsah
and ripped open all the pregnant women. 17 In the thirty-ninth year of Azariah's
reign over Judah, Menahem son of Gadi became king of Israel, and he reigned in
Samaria ten years. 18 And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, and throughout
his reign he did not turn away from the sins that Jeroboam son of Nebat had
caused Israel to commit. 19 Then Pul king of Assyria invaded the land, and
Menahem gave Pul a thousand talents of silver in order to gain his support
and strengthen his own grip on the kingdom. 20 Menahem exacted this money
from each of the wealthy men of Israel—fifty shekels of silver from each man
—to give to the king of Assyria. So the king of Assyria withdrew and did not
remain in the land. 21 As for the rest of the acts of Menahem, along with all his
accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings
of Israel? 22 And Menahem rested with his fathers, and his son Pekahiah reigned
in his place. 23 In the fiftieth year of Azariah's reign over Judah, Pekahiah son of
Menahem became king of Israel and reigned in Samaria two years. 24 And he did
evil in the sight of the LORD and did not turn away from the sins that Jeroboam
son of Nebat had caused Israel to commit.

25 Then his officer, Pekah son of Remaliah, conspired against him along with
Argob, Arieh, and fifty men of Gilead. And at the citadel of the king's palace in
Samaria, Pekah struck down and killed Pekahiah and reigned in his place. 26 As
for the rest of the acts of Pekahiah, along with all his accomplishments, they are
indeed written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel. 27 In the fifty-
second year of Azariah's reign over Judah, Pekah son of Remaliah became king
of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria twenty years. 28 And he did evil in the sight
of the LORD and did not turn away from the sins that Jeroboam son of Nebat
had caused Israel to commit. 29 In the days of Pekah king of Israel, Tiglath-pileser
king of Assyria came and captured Ijon, Abel-beth-maacah, Janoah, Kedesh,
Hazor, Gilead, and Galilee, including all the land of Naphtali, and he took
the people as captives to Assyria. 30 Then Hoshea son of Elah led a conspiracy
against Pekah son of Remaliah. In the twentieth year of Jotham son of Uzziah,
Hoshea attacked Pekah, killed him, and reigned in his place. 31 As for the rest of
the acts of Pekah, along with all his accomplishments, they are indeed written
in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Israel. 32 In the second year of the
reign of Pekah son of Remaliah over Israel, Jotham son of Uzziah became king
of Judah. 33 He was twenty-five years old when he became king, and he reigned
in Jerusalem sixteen years. His mother's name was Jerusha daughter of Zadok.
34 And he did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, just as his father Uzziah
had done. 35 Nevertheless, the high places were not taken away; the people
continued sacrificing and burning incense there. Jotham rebuilt the Upper Gate
of the house of the LORD. 36 As for the rest of the acts of Jotham, along with
his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the
Kings of Judah? 37 (In those days the LORD began to send Rezin king of Aram
and Pekah son of Remaliah against Judah.) 38 And Jotham rested with his fathers
and was buried with them in the City of David his father. And his son Ahaz
reigned in his place.

16 In the seventeenth year of Pekah son of Remaliah, Ahaz son of Jotham
became king of Judah. 2 Ahaz was twenty years old when he became king, and
he reigned in Jerusalem sixteen years. And unlike David his father, he did not
do what was right in the eyes of the LORD his God. 3 Instead, he walked in the
ways of the kings of Israel and even sacrificed his son in the fire, according to the
abominations of the nations that the LORD had driven out before the Israelites.
4 And he sacrificed and burned incense on the high places, on the hills, and under
every green tree. 5 Then Rezin king of Aram and Pekah son of Remaliah king
of Israel came up to wage war against Jerusalem. They besieged Ahaz but could
not overcome him. 6 At that time Rezin king of Aram recovered Elath for Aram,
drove out the men of Judah, and sent the Edomites into Elath, where they live to
this day. 7 So Ahaz sent messengers to Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria, saying, "I
am your servant and your son. Come up and save me from the hands of the kings
of Aram and Israel, who are rising up against me." 8 Ahaz also took the silver and
gold found in the house of the LORD and in the treasuries of the king's palace,
and he sent it as a gift to the king of Assyria. 9 So the king of Assyria responded
to him, marched up to Damascus, and captured it. He took its people to Kir as
captives and put Rezin to death.

10 Then King Ahaz went to Damascus to meet Tiglath-pileser king of Assyria. On seeing the altar in Damascus, King Ahaz sent Uriah the priest a model of the altar and complete plans for its construction. 11 And Uriah the priest built the altar according to all the instructions King Ahaz had sent from Damascus, and he completed it by the time King Ahaz had returned. 12 When the king came back from Damascus and saw the altar, he approached it and presented offerings on it. 13 He offered his burnt offering and his grain offering, poured out his drink offering, and sprinkled the blood of his peace offerings on the altar. 14 He also took the bronze altar that stood before the LORD from the front of the temple (between the new altar and the house of the LORD) and he put it on the north side of the new altar. 15 Then King Ahaz commanded Uriah the priest, "Offer on the great altar the morning burnt offering, the evening grain offering, and the king's burnt offering and grain offering, as well as the burnt offerings, grain offerings, and drink offerings of all the people of the land. Sprinkle on the altar all the blood of the burnt offerings and sacrifices. But I will use the bronze altar to seek guidance." 16 So Uriah the priest did just as King Ahaz had commanded. 17 King Ahaz also cut off the frames of the movable stands and removed the bronze basin from each of them. He took down the Sea from the bronze oxen that were under it and put it on a stone base. 18 And on account of the king of Assyria, he removed the Sabbath canopy they had built in the temple and closed the royal entryway outside the house of the LORD. 19 As for the rest of the acts of Ahaz, along with his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? 20 And Ahaz rested with his fathers and was buried with them in the City of David, and his son Hezekiah reigned in his place.

17 In the twelfth year of the reign of Ahaz over Judah, Hoshea son of Elah became king of Israel, and he reigned in Samaria nine years. 2 And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, but not like the kings of Israel who preceded him. 3 Shalmaneser king of Assyria attacked him, and Hoshea became his vassal and paid him tribute. 4 But the king of Assyria discovered that Hoshea had conspired to send envoys to King So of Egypt, and that he had not paid tribute to the king of Assyria as in previous years. Therefore the king of Assyria arrested Hoshea and put him in prison. 5 Then the king of Assyria invaded the whole land, marched up to Samaria, and besieged it for three years. 6 In the ninth year of Hoshea, the king of Assyria captured Samaria and carried away the Israelites to Assyria, where he settled them in Halah, in Gozan by the Habor River, and in the cities of the Medes. 7 All this happened because the people of Israel had sinned against the LORD their God, who had brought them out of the land of Egypt from under the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt. They had worshiped other gods 8 and walked in the customs of the nations that the LORD had driven out before the Israelites, as well as in the practices introduced by the kings of Israel. 9 The Israelites secretly did things against the LORD their God that were not right. From watchtower to fortified city, they built high places in all their cities. 10 They set up for themselves sacred pillars and Asherah poles on every high hill and under every green tree. 11 They burned incense on all the high places like the nations that the LORD had driven out before them. They did wicked things, provoking the LORD to anger. 12 They served idols, although the LORD had told them, "You shall not do this thing."

13 Yet through all His prophets and seers, the LORD warned Israel and Judah, saying, "Turn from your wicked ways and keep My commandments and statutes, according to the entire Law that I commanded your fathers and delivered to you through My servants the prophets." 14 But they would not listen, and they stiffened their necks like their fathers, who did not believe the LORD their God. 15 They rejected His statutes and the covenant He had made with their fathers, as well as the decrees He had given them. They pursued worthless idols and themselves became worthless, going after the surrounding nations that the LORD had commanded them not to imitate. 16 They abandoned all the commandments of the LORD their God and made for themselves two cast idols of calves and an Asherah pole. They bowed down to all the host of heaven and served Baal. 17 They sacrificed their sons and daughters in the fire and practiced divination and soothsaying. They devoted themselves to doing evil in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger. 18 So the LORD was very angry with Israel, and He removed them from His presence. Only the tribe of Judah remained, 19 and even Judah did not keep the commandments of the LORD their God, but lived according to the customs Israel had introduced. 20 So the LORD rejected all the descendants of Israel. He afflicted them and delivered them into the hands of plunderers, until He had banished them from His presence. 21 When the LORD had torn Israel away from the house of David, they made Jeroboam son of Nebat king, and Jeroboam led Israel away from following the LORD and caused them to commit a great sin. 22 The Israelites persisted in all the sins that Jeroboam had committed and did not turn away from them. 23 Finally, the LORD removed Israel from His presence, as He had declared through all His servants the prophets. So Israel was exiled from their homeland into Assyria, where they are to this day. 24 Then the king of Assyria brought people from Babylon, Cuthah, Avva, Hamath, and Sepharvaim and settled them in the towns of Samaria to replace the Israelites. They took possession of Samaria and lived in its towns. 25 Now when the settlers first lived there, they did not worship the LORD, so He sent lions among them, which killed some of them.

26 So they spoke to the king of Assyria, saying, "The peoples that you have removed and placed in the cities of Samaria do not know the requirements of the God of the land. Because of this, He has sent lions among them, which are indeed killing them off."

27 Then the king of Assyria commanded: "Send back one of the priests you carried off from Samaria, and have him go back to live there and teach the requirements of the God of the land." 28 Thus one of the priests they had carried away came and lived in Bethel, and he began to teach them how they should worship the LORD. 29 Nevertheless, the people of each nation continued to make their own gods in the cities where they had settled, and they set them up in the shrines that the people of Samaria had made on the high places. 30 The men of Babylon made Succoth-benoth, the men of Cuth made Nergal, the men of Hamath made Ashima, 31 the Avvites made Nibhaz and Tartak, and the Sepharvites burned their children in the fire to Adrammelech and Anammelech the gods of Sepharvaim. 32 So the new residents worshiped the LORD, but they also appointed for themselves priests of all sorts to serve in the shrines of the high places. 33 They worshiped the LORD, but they also served their own gods according to the customs of the nations from which they had been carried away. 34 To this day they are still practicing their former customs. None of them worship the LORD or observe the statutes, ordinances, laws, and commandments that the LORD gave the descendants of Jacob, whom He named Israel. 35 For the LORD had made a covenant with the Israelites and commanded them, "Do not worship other gods or bow down to them; do not serve them or sacrifice to them." 36 Instead, worship the LORD, who brought you out of the land of Egypt with great power and an outstretched arm. You are to bow down to Him and offer sacrifices to Him. 37 And you must always be careful to observe the statutes, ordinances, laws, and commandments He wrote for you. Do not worship other gods. 38 Do not forget the covenant I have made with you. Do not worship other gods, 39 "but worship the LORD your God, and He will deliver you from the hands of all your enemies." 40 But they would not listen, and they persisted in their former customs. 41 So these nations worshiped the LORD but also served their idols, and to this day their children and grandchildren continue to do as their fathers did.

18 In the third year of the reign of Hoshea son of Elah over Israel, Hezekiah son of Ahaz became king of Judah. 2 He was twenty-five years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem twenty-nine years. His mother's name was Abi, the daughter of Zechariah. 3 And he did what was right in the eyes of the LORD, just as his father David had done. 4 He removed the high places, shattered the sacred pillars, and cut down the Asherah poles. He also demolished the bronze snake called Nehushtan that Moses had made, for up to that time the Israelites had burned incense to it. 5 Hezekiah trusted in the LORD, the God of Israel. No king of Judah was like him, either before him or after him. 6 He remained faithful to the LORD and did not turn from following Him; he kept the commandments that the LORD had given Moses. 7 And the LORD was with Hezekiah, and he prospered wherever he went. He rebelled against the king of Assyria and refused to serve him. 8 He defeated the Philistines as far as Gaza and its borders, from watchtower to fortified city. 9 In the fourth year of Hezekiah's reign, which was the seventh year of the reign of Hoshea son of Elah over Israel, Shalmaneser king of Assyria marched against Samaria and besieged it. 10 And at the end of three years, the Assyrians captured it. So Samaria was captured in the sixth year of Hezekiah, which was the ninth year of Hoshea king of Israel. 11 The king of Assyria exiled the Israelites to Assyria and settled them in Halah, in Gozan by the Habor River, and in the cities of the Medes.

12 This happened because they did not listen to the voice of the LORD their God, but violated His covenant—all that Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded—and would neither listen nor obey. 13 In the fourteenth year of Hezekiah's reign, Sennacherib king of Assyria attacked and captured all the fortified cities of Judah. 14 So Hezekiah king of Judah sent word to the king of Assyria at Lachish, saying, "I have done wrong; withdraw from me, and I will pay whatever you demand from me." And the king of Assyria exacted from Hezekiah king of Judah three hundred talents of silver and thirty talents of gold. 15 Hezekiah gave him all the silver that was found in the house of the LORD and in the treasuries of the royal palace.

16 At that time Hezekiah stripped the gold with which he had plated the doors and doorposts of the temple of the LORD, and he gave it to the king of Assyria. 17 Nevertheless, the king of Assyria sent the Tartan, the Rabsaris, and the Rabshakeh, along with a great army, from Lachish to King Hezekiah at Jerusalem. They advanced up to Jerusalem and stationed themselves by the aqueduct of the upper pool, on the road to the Launderer's Field. 18 Then they called for the king; and Eliakim son of Hilkiah the palace administrator, Shebnah the scribe, and Joah son of Asaph the recorder, went out to them. 19 The Rabshakeh said to them, "Tell Hezekiah that this is what the great king, the king of Assyria, says: What is the basis of this confidence of yours?" 20 You claim to have a strategy and strength for war, but these are empty words. In whom are you now trusting, that you have rebelled against me? 21 Look now, you are trusting in Egypt, that splintered reed of a staff that will pierce the hand of anyone who leans on it. Such is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who trust in him. 22 But if you say to me, 'We trust in the LORD our God,' is He not the One whose high places and altars Hezekiah has removed, saying to Judah and Jerusalem: 'You must worship before this altar in Jerusalem'? 23 Now, therefore, make a bargain with my master, the king of Assyria. I will give you two thousand horses—if you can put riders on them!

24 For how can you repel a single officer among the least of my master's servants when you depend on Egypt for chariots and horsemen? 25 "So now, was it apart

from the LORD that I have come up against this place to destroy it? The LORD Himself said to me, 'Go up against this land and destroy it.'" [26] Then Eliakim son of Hilkiah, along with Shebnah and Joah, said to the Rabshakeh, "Please speak to your servants in Aramaic, since we understand it. Do not speak with us in Hebrew in the hearing of the people on the wall." [27] But the Rabshakeh replied, "Has my master sent me to speak these words only to you and your master, and not to the men sitting on the wall, who are destined with you to eat their own dung and drink their own urine?" [28] Then the Rabshakeh stood and called out loudly in Hebrew: "Hear the word of the great king, the king of Assyria!" [29] This is what the king says: Do not let Hezekiah deceive you; he cannot deliver you from my hand. [30] Do not let Hezekiah persuade you to trust in the LORD when he says, 'The LORD will surely deliver us; this city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.' [31] Do not listen to Hezekiah, for this is what the king of Assyria says: Make peace with me and come out to me. Then every one of you will eat from his own vine and his own fig tree, and drink water from his own cistern, [32] until I come and take you away to a land like your own—a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olive trees and honey—so that you may live and not die. But do not listen to Hezekiah, for he misleads you when he says, 'The LORD will deliver us.' [33] Has the god of any nation ever delivered his land from the hand of the king of Assyria? [34] Where are the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah? Have they delivered Samaria from my hand? [35] "Who among all the gods of these lands has delivered his land from my hand? How then can the LORD deliver Jerusalem from my hand?" [36] But the people remained silent and did not answer a word, for Hezekiah had commanded, "Do not answer him." [37] Then Hilkiah's son Eliakim the palace administrator, Shebna the scribe, and Asaph's son Joah the recorder came to Hezekiah with their clothes torn, and they relayed to him the words of the Rabshakeh.

19 On hearing this report, King Hezekiah tore his clothes, put on sackcloth, and entered the house of the LORD. [2] And he sent Eliakim the palace administrator, Shebna the scribe, and the leading priests, all wearing sackcloth, to the prophet Isaiah son of Amoz [3] to tell him, "This is what Hezekiah says: Today is a day of distress, rebuke, and disgrace; for children have come to the point of birth, but there is no strength to deliver them." [4] "Perhaps the LORD your God will hear all the words of the Rabshakeh, whom his master the king of Assyria has sent to defy the living God, and He will rebuke him for the words that the LORD your God has heard. Therefore lift up a prayer for the remnant that still survives." [5] So the servants of King Hezekiah went to Isaiah, [6] who replied, "Tell your master that this is what the LORD says: 'Do not be afraid of the words you have heard, with which the servants of the king of Assyria have blasphemed Me.'" [7] "Behold, I will put a spirit in him so that he will hear a rumor and return to his own land, where I will cause him to fall by the sword.'" [8] When the Rabshakeh heard that the king of Assyria had left Lachish, he withdrew and found the king fighting against Libnah. [9] Now Sennacherib had been warned about Tirhakah king of Cush: "Look, he has set out to fight against you." So Sennacherib again sent messengers to Hezekiah, saying, [10] "Give this message to Hezekiah king of Judah: 'Do not let your God, in whom you trust, deceive you by saying that Jerusalem will not be delivered into the hand of the king of Assyria.'" [11] Surely you have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all the other countries, devoting them to destruction. Will you then be spared?

[12] Did the gods of the nations destroyed by my fathers rescue those nations—the gods of Gozan, Haran, and Rezeph, and of the people of Eden in Telassar? [13] "Where are the kings of Hamath, Arpad, Sepharvaim, Hena, and Ivvah?'" [14] So Hezekiah received the letter from the messengers, read it, and went up to the house of the LORD and spread it out before the LORD. [15] And Hezekiah prayed before the LORD: "O LORD, God of Israel, enthroned between the cherubim, You alone are God over all the kingdoms of the earth. You made the heavens and the earth." [16] Incline Your ear, O LORD, and hear; open Your eyes, O LORD, and see. Listen to the words that Sennacherib has sent to defy the living God. [17] Truly, O LORD, the kings of Assyria have laid waste these nations and their lands. [18] They have cast their gods into the fire and destroyed them, for they were not gods, but only wood and stone—the work of human hands. [19] "And now, O LORD our God, please save us from his hand, so that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that You alone, O LORD, are God."

[20] Then Isaiah son of Amoz sent a message to Hezekiah: "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: I have heard your prayer concerning Sennacherib king of Assyria." [21] This is the word that the LORD has spoken against him: 'The Virgin Daughter of Zion despises you and mocks you; the Daughter of Jerusalem shakes her head behind you.' [22] Whom have you taunted and blasphemed? Against whom have you raised your voice and lifted your eyes in pride? Against the Holy One of Israel! [23] Through your servants you have taunted the Lord, and you have said: "With my many chariots I have ascended to the heights of the mountains, to the remote peaks of Lebanon. I have cut down its tallest cedars, the finest of its cypresses. I have reached its farthest outposts, the densest of its forests."

[24] "I have dug wells and drunk foreign waters. With the soles of my feet I have dried up all the streams of Egypt." [25] Have you not heard? Long ago I ordained it; in days of old I planned it. Now I have brought it to pass, that you should crush fortified cities into piles of rubble. [26] Therefore their inhabitants, devoid of power, are dismayed and ashamed. They are like plants in the field, tender green shoots, grass on the rooftops, scorched before it is grown. [27] But I know your sitting down, your going out and coming in, and your raging against Me. [28] Because your rage and arrogance against Me have reached My ears, I will put My hook in your nose and My bit in your mouth; I will send you back the way you came.' [29] And this will be a sign to you, O Hezekiah: This year you will eat what grows on its own, and in the second year what springs from the same. But in the third year you will sow and reap; you will plant vineyards and eat their fruit. [30] And the surviving remnant of the house of Judah will again take root below and bear fruit above. [31] For a remnant will go forth from Jerusalem, and survivors from Mount Zion. The zeal of the LORD of Hosts will accomplish this. [32] So this is what the LORD says about the king of Assyria: 'He will not enter this city or shoot an arrow into it. He will not come before it with a shield or build up a siege ramp against it.' [33] He will go back the way he came, and he will not enter this city,' declares the LORD. [34] "'I will defend this city and save it for My own sake and for the sake of My servant David.'" [35] And that very night the angel of the LORD went out and struck down 185,000 men in the camp of the Assyrians. When the people got up the next morning, there were all the dead bodies! [36] So Sennacherib king of Assyria broke camp and withdrew. He returned to Nineveh and stayed there. [37] One day, while he was worshiping in the temple of his god Nisroch, his sons Adrammelech and Sharezer put him to the sword and escaped to the land of Ararat. And his son Esar-haddon reigned in his place.

20 In those days Hezekiah became mortally ill. The prophet Isaiah son of Amoz came to him and said, "This is what the LORD says: 'Put your house in order, for you are about to die; you will not recover.'" [2] Then Hezekiah turned his face to the wall and prayed to the LORD, saying, [3] "Please, O LORD, remember how I have walked before You faithfully and with wholehearted devotion; I have done what was good in Your sight." And Hezekiah wept bitterly. [4] Before Isaiah had left the middle courtyard, the word of the LORD came to him, saying, [5] "Go back and tell Hezekiah the leader of My people that this is what the LORD, the God of your father David, says: 'I have heard your prayer; I have seen your tears. I will surely heal you. On the third day from now you will go up to the house of the LORD.'" [6] "I will add fifteen years to your life. And I will deliver you and this city from the hand of the king of Assyria. I will defend this city for My sake and for the sake of My servant David.'"

[7] Then Isaiah said, "Prepare a poultice of figs." So they brought it and applied it to the boil, and Hezekiah recovered. [8] Now Hezekiah had asked Isaiah, "What will be the sign that the LORD will heal me and that I will go up to the house of the LORD on the third day?" [9] And Isaiah had replied, "This will be a sign to you from the LORD that He will do what He has promised: Would you like the shadow to go forward ten steps, or back ten steps?" [10] "It is easy for the shadow to lengthen ten steps," answered Hezekiah, "but not for it to go back ten steps."

[11] So Isaiah the prophet called out to the LORD, and He brought the shadow back the ten steps it had descended on the stairway of Ahaz. [12] At that time Merodach-baladan son of Baladan king of Babylon sent letters and a gift to Hezekiah, for he had heard about Hezekiah's illness. [13] And Hezekiah received the envoys and showed them all that was in his treasure house—the silver, the gold, the spices, and the precious oil, as well as his armory—all that was found in his storehouses. There was nothing in his palace or in all his dominion that Hezekiah did not show them.

[14] Then the prophet Isaiah went to King Hezekiah and asked, "Where did those men come from, and what did they say to you?" "They came from a distant land," Hezekiah replied, "from Babylon." [15] "What have they seen in your palace?" Isaiah asked. "They have seen everything in my palace," answered Hezekiah. "There is nothing among my treasures that I did not show them." [16] Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear the word of the LORD:" [17] The time will surely come when everything in your palace and all that your fathers have stored up until this day will be carried off to Babylon. Nothing will be left, says the LORD. [18] "And some of your descendants, your own flesh and blood, will be taken away to be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon." [19] But Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "The word of the LORD that you have spoken is good." For he thought, "Will there not at least be peace and security in my lifetime?" [20] As for the rest of the acts of Hezekiah, along with all his might and how he constructed the pool and the tunnel to bring water into the city, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? [21] And Hezekiah rested with his fathers, and his son Manasseh reigned in his place.

21 Manasseh was twelve years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem fifty-five years. His mother's name was Hephzibah. [2] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD by following the abominations of the nations that the LORD had driven out before the Israelites. [3] For he rebuilt the high places that his father Hezekiah had destroyed, and he raised up altars for Baal. He made an Asherah pole, as King Ahab of Israel had done, and he worshiped and served all the host of heaven. [4] Manasseh also built altars in the house of the LORD, of which the LORD had said, "In Jerusalem I will put My Name." [5] In both courtyards of the house of the LORD, he built altars to all the host of heaven. [6] He sacrificed his own son in the fire, practiced sorcery and divination, and consulted mediums and spiritists. He did great evil in the sight of the LORD, provoking Him to anger. [7] Manasseh even took the carved Asherah pole he had made and set it up in the temple, of which the LORD had said to David and his son Solomon, "In this temple and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, I will establish My Name forever."

[8] "I will never again cause the feet of the Israelites to wander from the land
that I gave to their fathers, if only they are careful to do all I have commanded
them—the whole Law that My servant Moses commanded them." [9] But the
people did not listen and Manasseh led them astray, so that they did greater evil
than the nations that the LORD had destroyed before the Israelites. [10] And the
LORD spoke through His servants the prophets, saying, [11] "Since Manasseh king
of Judah has committed all these abominations, acting more wickedly than the
Amorites who preceded him, and with his idols has caused Judah to sin," [12] this
is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I am bringing such calamity
upon Jerusalem and Judah that the news will reverberate in the ears of all who
hear it.'

[13] I will stretch out over Jerusalem the measuring line used against Samaria and
the plumb line used against the house of Ahab, and I will wipe out Jerusalem as
one wipes out a bowl—wiping it and turning it upside down. [14] So I will forsake
the remnant of My inheritance and deliver them into the hands of their enemies.
And they will become plunder and spoil to all their enemies, [15] "because they
have done evil in My sight and have provoked Me to anger from the day their
fathers came out of Egypt until this day.'" [16] Moreover, Manasseh shed so much
innocent blood that he filled Jerusalem from end to end, in addition to the sin
that he had caused Judah to commit, doing evil in the sight of the LORD.

[17] As for the rest of the acts of Manasseh, along with all his accomplishments and
the sin that he committed, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of
the Kings of Judah? [18] And Manasseh rested with his fathers and was buried in
his palace garden, the garden of Uzza. And his son Amon reigned in his place.
[19] Amon was twenty-two years old when he became king, and he reigned in
Jerusalem two years. His mother's name was Meshullemeth daughter of Haruz;
she was from Jotbah. [20] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, as his father
Manasseh had done. [21] He walked in all the ways of his father, and he served and
worshiped the idols his father had served. [22] He abandoned the LORD, the God
of his fathers, and did not walk in the way of the LORD. [23] Then the servants of
Amon conspired against him and killed the king in his palace. [24] But the people of
the land killed all those who had conspired against King Amon, and they made
his son Josiah king in his place. [25] As for the rest of the acts of Amon, along with
his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the
Kings of Judah? [26] And he was buried in his tomb in the garden of Uzza, and his
son Josiah reigned in his place.

22 Josiah was eight years old when he became king, and he reigned in
Jerusalem thirty-one years. His mother's name was Jedidah daughter of Adaiah;
she was from Bozkath. [2] And he did what was right in the eyes of the LORD
and walked in all the ways of his father David; he did not turn aside to the
right or to the left. [3] Now in the eighteenth year of his reign, King Josiah sent
the scribe, Shaphan son of Azaliah, the son of Meshullam, to the house of
the LORD, saying, [4] "Go up to Hilkiah the high priest and have him count
the money that has been brought into the house of the LORD, which the
doorkeepers have collected from the people." [5] And let them deliver it into the
hands of the supervisors of those doing the work on the house of the LORD,
who in turn are to give it to the workmen repairing the damages to the house
of the LORD— [6] to the carpenters, builders, and masons—to buy timber and
dressed stone to repair the temple. [7] "But they need not account for the money
put into their hands, since they work with integrity." [8] Then Hilkiah the high
priest said to Shaphan the scribe, "I have found the Book of the Law in the house
of the LORD!" And he gave it to Shaphan, who read it. [9] And Shaphan the
scribe went to the king and reported, "Your servants have paid out the money
that was found in the temple and have put it into the hands of the workers
and supervisors of the house of the LORD." [10] Moreover, Shaphan the scribe
told the king, "Hilkiah the priest has given me a book." And Shaphan read it in
the presence of the king. [11] When the king heard the words of the Book of the
Law, he tore his clothes [12] and commanded Hilkiah the priest, Ahikam son of
Shaphan, Achbor son of Micaiah, Shaphan the scribe, and Asaiah the servant
of the king: [13] "Go and inquire of the LORD for me, for the people, and for all
Judah concerning the words in this book that has been found. For great is the
wrath of the LORD that burns against us because our fathers have not obeyed
the words of this book by doing all that is written about us."

[14] So Hilkiah the priest, Ahikam, Achbor, Shaphan, and Asaiah went and spoke
to Huldah the prophetess, the wife of Shallum son of Tikvah, the son of Harhas,
the keeper of the wardrobe. She lived in Jerusalem, in the Second District.
[15] And Huldah said to them, "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says:
'Tell the man who sent you'" [16] that this is what the LORD says: I am about
to bring calamity on this place and on its people, according to all the words of
the book that the king of Judah has read, [17] because they have forsaken Me and
burned incense to other gods, that they might provoke Me to anger with all the
works of their hands. My wrath will be kindled against this place and will not
be quenched.' [18] But as for the king of Judah, who sent you to inquire of the
LORD, tell him that this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'As for
the words that you heard,' [19] because your heart was tender and you humbled
yourself before the LORD when you heard what I spoke against this place and
against its people, that they would become a desolation and a curse, and because
you have torn your clothes and wept before Me, I have heard you,' declares
the LORD. [20] "'Therefore I will indeed gather you to your fathers, and you will
be gathered to your grave in peace. Your eyes will not see all the calamity that I
will bring on this place.'" So they brought her answer back to the king.

23 Then the king summoned all the elders of Judah and Jerusalem. [2] And
he went up to the house of the LORD with all the people of Judah and
Jerusalem, as well as the priests and the prophets—all the people small and great
—and in their hearing he read all the words of the Book of the Covenant that
had been found in the house of the LORD. [3] So the king stood by the pillar
and made a covenant before the LORD to follow the LORD and to keep His
commandments, decrees, and statutes with all his heart and all his soul, and to
carry out the words of this covenant that were written in this book. And all the
people entered into the covenant. [4] Then the king commanded Hilkiah the high
priest, the priests second in rank, and the doorkeepers to remove from the temple
of the LORD all the articles made for Baal, Asherah, and all the host of heaven.
And he burned them outside Jerusalem in the fields of Kidron and carried their
ashes to Bethel. [5] Josiah also did away with the idolatrous priests ordained by the
kings of Judah to burn incense on the high places of the cities of Judah and in
the places all around Jerusalem—those who had burned incense to Baal, to the
sun and moon, to the constellations, and to all the host of heaven. [6] He brought
the Asherah pole from the house of the LORD to the Kidron Valley outside
Jerusalem, and there he burned it, ground it to powder, and threw its dust on
the graves of the common people. [7] He also tore down the quarters of the male
shrine prostitutes that were in the house of the LORD, where the women had
woven tapestries for Asherah. [8] Then Josiah brought all the priests from the
cities of Judah and desecrated the high places, from Geba to Beersheba, where
the priests had burned incense. He tore down the high places of the gates at the
entrance of the gate of Joshua the governor of the city, which was to the left of
the city gate. [9] Although the priests of the high places did not come up to the altar
of the LORD in Jerusalem, they ate unleavened bread with their fellow priests.
[10] He also desecrated Topheth in the Valley of Ben-hinnom so that no one could
sacrifice his son or daughter in the fire to Molech. [11] And he removed from the
entrance to the house of the LORD the horses that the kings of Judah had
dedicated to the sun. They were in the court near the chamber of an official
named Nathan-melech. And Josiah burned up the chariots of the sun.

[12] He pulled down the altars that the kings of Judah had set up on the roof
near the upper chamber of Ahaz, and the altars that Manasseh had set up in
the two courtyards of the house of the LORD. The king pulverized them there
and threw their dust into the Kidron Valley. [13] The king also desecrated the high
places east of Jerusalem, to the south of the Mount of Corruption, which King
Solomon of Israel had built for Ashtoreth the abomination of the Sidonians, for
Chemosh the abomination of the Moabites, and for Milcom the abomination of
the Ammonites. [14] He smashed the sacred pillars to pieces, cut down the Asherah
poles, and covered the sites with human bones. [15] He even pulled down the altar
at Bethel, the high place set up by Jeroboam son of Nebat, who had caused Israel
to sin. Then he burned the high place, ground it to powder, and burned the
Asherah pole. [16] And as Josiah turned, he saw the tombs there on the hillside,
and he sent someone to take the bones out of the tombs, and he burned them
on the altar to defile it, according to the word of the LORD proclaimed by the
man of God who had foretold these things. [17] Then the king asked, "What is this
monument I see?" And the men of the city replied, "It is the tomb of the man
of God who came from Judah and pronounced these things that you have done
to the altar of Bethel." [18] "Let him rest," said Josiah. "Do not let anyone disturb
his bones." So they left his bones undisturbed, along with those of the prophet
who had come from Samaria. [19] Just as Josiah had done at Bethel, so also in the
cities of Samaria he removed all the shrines of the high places set up by the kings
of Israel who had provoked the LORD to anger. [20] On the altars he slaughtered
all the priests of the high places, and he burned human bones on them. Then he
returned to Jerusalem.

[21] The king commanded all the people, "Keep the Passover of the LORD your
God, as it is written in this Book of the Covenant." [22] No such Passover had been
observed from the days of the judges who had governed Israel through all the
days of the kings of Israel and Judah. [23] But in the eighteenth year of Josiah's
reign, this Passover was observed to the LORD in Jerusalem.

[24] Furthermore, Josiah removed the mediums and spiritists, the household gods
and idols, and all the abominations that were seen in the land of Judah and in
Jerusalem. He did this to carry out the words of the law written in the book that
Hilkiah the priest had found in the house of the LORD. [25] Neither before nor
after Josiah was there any king like him, who turned to the LORD with all his
heart and with all his soul and with all his strength, according to all the Law
of Moses. [26] Nevertheless, the LORD did not turn away from the fury of His
burning anger, which was kindled against Judah because of all that Manasseh had
done to provoke Him to anger. [27] For the LORD had said, "I will remove Judah
from My sight, just as I removed Israel. I will reject this city Jerusalem, which I
chose, and the temple of which I said, 'My Name shall be there.'" [28] As for the
rest of the acts of Josiah, along with all his accomplishments, are they not written
in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? [29] At the end of Josiah's
reign, Pharaoh Neco king of Egypt marched up to help the king of Assyria at the
Euphrates River. King Josiah went out to confront him, but Neco faced him and
killed him at Megiddo. [30] From Megiddo his servants carried his body in a chariot,
brought him to Jerusalem, and buried him in his own tomb. Then the people of
the land took Jehoahaz son of Josiah, anointed him, and made him king in place

of his father. [31] Jehoahaz was twenty-three years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem three months. His mother's name was Hamutal daughter of Jeremiah; she was from Libnah. [32] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, just as his fathers had done. [33] And Pharaoh Neco imprisoned Jehoahaz at Riblah in the land of Hamath so that he could not reign in Jerusalem, and he imposed on Judah a levy of a hundred talents of silver and a talent of gold. [34] Then Pharaoh Neco made Eliakim son of Josiah king in place of his father Josiah, and he changed Eliakim's name to Jehoiakim. But Neco took Jehoahaz and carried him off to Egypt, where he died. [35] So Jehoiakim paid the silver and gold to Pharaoh Neco, but to meet Pharaoh's demand he taxed the land and exacted the silver and the gold from the people, each according to his wealth. [36] Jehoiakim was twenty-five years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem eleven years. His mother's name was Zebidah daughter of Pedaiah; she was from Rumah. [37] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, just as his fathers had done.

24 During Jehoiakim's reign, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon invaded. So Jehoiakim became his vassal for three years, until he turned and rebelled against Nebuchadnezzar. [2] And the LORD sent Chaldean, Aramean, Moabite, and Ammonite raiders against Jehoiakim in order to destroy Judah, according to the word that the LORD had spoken through His servants the prophets. [3] Surely this happened to Judah at the LORD's command, to remove them from His presence because of the sins of Manasseh and all that he had done, [4] and also for the innocent blood he had shed. For he had filled Jerusalem with innocent blood, and the LORD was unwilling to forgive. [5] As for the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, along with all his accomplishments, are they not written in the Book of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah? [6] And Jehoiakim rested with his fathers, and his son Jehoiachin reigned in his place. [7] Now the king of Egypt did not march out of his land again, because the king of Babylon had taken all his territory, from the Brook of Egypt to the Euphrates River. [8] Jehoiachin was eighteen years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem three months. His mother's name was Nehushta daughter of Elnathan; she was from Jerusalem. [9] And he did evil in the sight of the LORD, just as his father had done. [10] At that time the servants of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon marched up to Jerusalem, and the city came under siege. [11] And Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came to the city while his servants were besieging it.

[12] Jehoiachin king of Judah, his mother, his servants, his commanders, and his officials all surrendered to the king of Babylon. So in the eighth year of his reign, the king of Babylon took him captive. [13] As the LORD had declared, Nebuchadnezzar also carried off all the treasures from the house of the LORD and the royal palace, and he cut into pieces all the gold articles that Solomon king of Israel had made in the temple of the LORD. [14] He carried into exile all Jerusalem—all the commanders and mighty men of valor, all the craftsmen and metalsmiths—ten thousand captives in all. Only the poorest people of the land remained. [15] Nebuchadnezzar carried away Jehoiachin to Babylon, as well as the king's mother, his wives, his officials, and the leading men of the land. He took them into exile from Jerusalem to Babylon. [16] The king of Babylon also brought into exile to Babylon all seven thousand men of valor and a thousand craftsmen and metalsmiths—all strong and fit for battle. [17] Then the king of Babylon made Mattaniah, Jehoiachin's uncle, king in his place and changed his name to Zedekiah. [18] Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he became king, and he reigned in Jerusalem eleven years. His mother's name was Hamutal daughter of Jeremiah; she was from Libnah. [19] And Zedekiah did evil in the sight of the LORD, just as Jehoiakim had done. [20] For because of the anger of the LORD, all this happened in Jerusalem and Judah, until He finally banished them from His presence. And Zedekiah also rebelled against the king of Babylon.

25 So in the ninth year of Zedekiah's reign, on the tenth day of the tenth month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon marched against Jerusalem with his entire army. They encamped outside the city and built a siege wall all around it. [2] And the city was kept under siege until King Zedekiah's eleventh year. [3] By the ninth day of the fourth month, the famine in the city was so severe that the people of the land had no food. [4] Then the city was breached; and though the Chaldeans had surrounded the city, all the men of war fled by night by way of the gate between the two walls near the king's garden. They headed toward the Arabah, [5] but the army of the Chaldeans pursued the king and overtook him in the plains of Jericho, and all his army was separated from him. [6] The Chaldeans seized the king and brought him up to the king of Babylon at Riblah, where they pronounced judgment on him. [7] And they slaughtered the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes. Then they put out his eyes, bound him with bronze shackles, and took him to Babylon. [8] On the seventh day of the fifth month, in the nineteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar's reign over Babylon, Nebuzaradan captain of the guard, a servant of the king of Babylon, entered Jerusalem. [9] He burned down the house of the LORD, the royal palace, and all the houses of Jerusalem—every significant building.

[10] And the whole army of the Chaldeans under the captain of the guard broke down the walls around Jerusalem. [11] Then Nebuzaradan captain of the guard carried into exile the people who remained in the city, along with the deserters who had defected to the king of Babylon and the rest of the population. [12] But the captain of the guard left behind some of the poorest of the land to tend the vineyards and fields. [13] Moreover, the Chaldeans broke up the bronze pillars and stands and the bronze Sea in the house of the LORD, and they carried the bronze to Babylon.

[14] They also took away the pots, shovels, wick trimmers, dishes, and all the articles of bronze used in the temple service. [15] The captain of the guard also took away the censers and sprinkling bowls—anything made of pure gold or fine silver. [16] As for the two pillars, the Sea, and the movable stands that Solomon had made for the house of the LORD, the weight of the bronze from all these articles was beyond measure. [17] Each pillar was eighteen cubits tall. The bronze capital atop one pillar was three cubits high, with a network of bronze pomegranates all around. The second pillar, with its network, was similar. [18] The captain of the guard also took away Seraiah the chief priest, Zephaniah the priest of second rank, and the three doorkeepers. [19] Of those still in the city, he took a court official who had been appointed over the men of war, as well as five royal advisors. He also took the scribe of the captain of the army, who had enlisted the people of the land, and sixty men who were found in the city.

[20] Nebuzaradan captain of the guard took them and brought them to the king of Babylon at Riblah. [21] There at Riblah in the land of Hamath, the king of Babylon struck them down and put them to death. So Judah was taken into exile, away from its own land. [22] Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon appointed Gedaliah son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, over the people he had left behind in the land of Judah. [23] When all the commanders of the armies and their men heard that the king of Babylon had appointed Gedaliah as governor, they came to Gedaliah at Mizpah—Ishmael son of Nethaniah, Johanan son of Kareah, Seraiah son of Tanhumeth the Netophathite, and Jaazaniah son of the Maacathite, as well as their men. [24] And Gedaliah took an oath before them and their men, assuring them, "Do not be afraid of the servants of the Chaldeans. Live in the land and serve the king of Babylon, and it will be well with you." [25] In the seventh month, however, Ishmael son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, who was a member of the royal family, came with ten men and struck down and killed Gedaliah, along with the Judeans and Chaldeans who were with him at Mizpah. [26] Then all the people small and great, together with the commanders of the army, arose and fled to Egypt for fear of the Chaldeans. [27] On the twenty-seventh day of the twelfth month of the thirty-seventh year of the exile of Judah's King Jehoiachin, in the year Evil-merodach became king of Babylon, he released King Jehoiachin of Judah from prison. [28] And he spoke kindly to Jehoiachin and set his throne above the thrones of the other kings who were with him in Babylon. [29] So Jehoiachin changed out of his prison clothes, and he dined regularly at the king's table for the rest of his life. [30] And the king provided Jehoiachin a daily portion for the rest of his life.

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